

DWAYNE PUGH

BACKEND & PLATFORM ENGINEER | DISTRIBUTED
SYSTEMS, DATA MODELING & CLOUD ARCHITECTURE

DETAILS

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SKILLS

Systems Architecture &
Boundary Design

● ● ● ● ● ○

Cloud Infrastructure &
Platform Engineering

● ● ● ● ● ●

CI/CD & Delivery
Architecture

● ● ● ● ● ●

Reliability Engineering &
Production Operations

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Backend/API & Service
Integration Reasoning

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Regulated Environment &
Security Mindset

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Engineering Mentorship &
Systems Thinking

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PROFILE

Backend and platform engineer specializing in designing resilient, scalable systems across cloud-native and regulated environments. Experienced in modernizing legacy applications, implementing GitOps and infrastructure-as-code strategies, and building clean integration boundaries between distributed services.

Strong systems thinker with a bias toward ownership — comfortable defining service contracts, modeling structured domain data, and building production-grade infrastructure that prioritizes reliability, observability, and security. Thrive in ambiguous, fast-moving environments where architecture, product, and infrastructure intersect.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

DevOps / Platform Engineer, California Department of Consumer Affairs

Sacramento, CA

Oct 2024 — Present

Leading modernization of a large-scale Java enterprise application deployed in OpenShift, focusing on long-term system stability, security, and architectural clarity.

Key Contributions

- Designed and implemented GitOps-based deployment workflows using ArgoCD and declarative configuration layering to improve system consistency and rollback safety.
- Designed structured environment overlays and configuration management strategies to isolate deployment concerns and reduce cross-environment drift.
- Improved security posture by integrating automated vulnerability scanning and policy enforcement directly into CI/CD pipelines.
- Participated in release governance and production readiness reviews, ensuring clear operational contracts between development and runtime environments.
- Instrumented system health monitoring using Prometheus, Grafana, and Splunk to improve visibility across distributed services.

Relevance to Backend/API Design

Worked extensively at service boundaries, ensuring clean integration contracts between application services, infrastructure components, and runtime configuration layers.

Agile Project Analyst / System Design Lead, California Department of Consumer Affairs

Sacramento, CA

Nov 2022 — Oct 2024

Acted as the translation layer between policy, product requirements, and system implementation for online licensing systems.

Key Contributions

- Defined system specifications, logical data models, and workflow mappings for multiple online licensing applications.

- Reduced application complexity by consolidating overlapping license types, decreasing development time by 60%.
- Structured user stories and interface definitions to ensure predictable implementation across frontend and backend components.
- Collaborated with development teams to clarify service boundaries, validation rules, and structured data requirements.

Relevance to Backend/API Design

Modeled domain entities and translated business requirements into structured system interfaces — effectively designing integration contracts even when not implementing the endpoints directly.

Software Engineer II – Platform Infrastructure, Rivian Automotive

Palo Alto, CA

May 2021 — Apr 2023

Supported large-scale distributed systems powering customer-facing services (vehicle configurator, purchasing, delivery scheduling, etc.) deployed on AWS.

Key Contributions

- Led production deployment of an Apache Flink streaming platform on EKS, including operational runbooks and developer integration guides.
- Managed 120+ service deployments and upgrades, performing production readiness checks focused on reliability, failure modes, and observability.
- Designed automation utilities to reduce deployment toil and maintain Terraform remote state consistency.
- Provided structured guidance to development teams deploying Lambda, DynamoDB, EC2, and containerized services.

Relevance to Backend/API Design

Worked closely with microservice architectures and AWS APIs, ensuring stable service interfaces, idempotent deployment patterns, and predictable integration behavior across distributed components.

DevOps Engineer, California Department of Consumer Affairs

Sacramento, CA

Jul 2019 — May 2021

- Led CI/CD modernization during a transition from Windows-based virtual machines to containerized workloads in OpenShift, improving deployment consistency and long-term platform portability.
- Reduced pipeline runtime from 8 hours to 2 hours by eliminating manual deployment steps, refactoring legacy scripts, and introducing structured automation patterns.
- Modernized CI/CD pipelines during a VM-to-OpenShift container transition; converted Windows-based deployment scripts to Linux shell workflows and contributed to build/deployment YAML definitions supporting containerized releases.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science – Cloud & Systems Administration, Western Governors University

Salt Lake City, UT

Apr 2018 — Present

Associate of Science – Network Design & Information Security, Sacramento City College

Sacramento, CA

Jan 2006 — May 2010